

LEC11 - Gender

Gender

Gender: The social construction of expected appearances, behaviours, and traits that are built around sex categories

Social Construction: The view that elements of our social world, including characteristics such as race, gender, and sexuality, are products of particular social and historical contexts and upheld by people and institutions

Learning Gender

- Gender socialization happens through interaction
 - Ex. Young children learning what toys are considered boy vs girl toys
 - A social construction is not something that is simply imagined and without consequences
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Implications of Gender

- Activities as gendered
 - Ex. cheerleading
 - Division of household labour
 - Male vs female labour (mowing lawn vs cooking)
 - “Bigorexia”
 - A body dysmorphic disorder characterized by individuals' desire to have less fat mass and obsession with increasing muscle mass
 - Gender wage gap
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Key Concepts

Division of household labour: The specialization of household tasks, especially between the tasks allocated to men and women

Gender ideology: Attitudes and beliefs about appropriate roles and responsibilities of women and men

Gender roles: Expectations for the behaviour of men and women, based on societal norms and standards

Second shift: The unpaid household labour expected of women in addition to the work performed in the paid labour market

How Policy Can Have An Impact

- Paternal leave in Quebec
 - 5 weeks exclusive for dads so that more dads can take time away from work and devote the time to their babies
- Flexible work arrangements
 - When an employee is given the flexibility to decide when they will complete their working hours
 - Ex. allows parents to take care of their kids after school then resume work